



Diego Morra

Curriculum Vitae

Personal informations

Nationality **Italian**
Mail **diegomorra.dm@gmail.com**
Website/Portfolio **diegomorraphd.com**

Education

- 2021 – 2025 **Ph.D. cum laude**
Information Technology
DEIB – Dipartimento di Elettronica, Informazione e Bioingegneria
Politecnico di Milano, Italy
- 2018 – 2021 **Master's Degree**
Communication Design
Politecnico di Milano, Italy
Thesis: COBO: a phygital interactive toolkit for co-designing interactive outdoor experiences with people with intellectual disability.
Score: 110 cum laude (min. 66 max. 110)
- 2015 – 2018 **Bachelor Degree**
Communication Design
Politecnico di Milano, Italy

Abroad experiences

- 02/2023 – 12/2023 **Visiting Ph.D.**
MIT Senseable City Lab
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Cambridge, MA, USA

Main work experiences

01/2021 – 06/2025 **Freelance UX/UI Designer & Front-End Developer**

Freelance activity as a user experience/user interface (UX/UI), graphic designer and consulting for a variety of clients and brands:

- SYEN electronics;
- Politecnico di Milano (*Mission Bambini Onlus*);
- Poste Italiane S.p.A.;
- Fondazione Politecnico di Milano;
- DM Company SRL (*UBS Bank, Absolute, Jameson, Malfy*);

01/2021 – 03/2021 **UX/UI & Data Visualization**

*Politecnico di
Milano*

Designer for a visual analytics tool to support decisions in the environmental field. Main goal of the activity was to design a multidimensional data visualization system geared toward decision support in the field of environmental management.

11/2019 – 02/2021 **Designer & Front-End Developer**

*Politecnico di
Milano*

Activities of graphic support for the definition and ideation of graphic artifacts and communication material for the Communication Office of Department of Electronics, Information and Bioengineering (DEIB). Responsibilities include executing tasks assigned by the manager to propose unique communication solutions with the goal of keeping the office in step with current trends.

04/2018 – 03/2021 **Designer**

DM Company SRL

Production of graphic and video content for digital communication and social campaigns for national and international brands such as UBS and LemonSoda. Responsible for the entire design process including all aspects of the brief, from the concept to the final design and development phase. Activity carried out by independently managing the timing and deadlines.

05/2020 – 09/2020 **Stage – Interaction Design**

TIS Lab

Design of an interactive toolkit and visual app to support a co-design method of interactive services for subjects with cognitive disorders, within the TIS Laboratory of Department of Electronics, Information and Bioengineering (DEIB). During the stage I carried out preliminary research activities which included defining the stakeholders of the project and conducting co-design workshops with users as well as questionnaire surveys aimed at evaluating the system and defining the interactive technologies required for the development of an advanced version of the system.

10/2018 – 09/2019 **Graphic and UX/UI Designer**

Lightdrop Srl

Content development and production for the development and launch of a social network startup (Coordinated Image, Pitch Deck, Crowdfunding Video) and support for the design and development of a mobile application user interface. Responsible for preparing the content and materials necessary to launch the startup's crowdfunding campaign, as well as putting together any artefacts capable of catching the attention of any investors or partners, both national and international.

Publications

- Chapter Morra, D.
Engaging People with Intellectual Disabilities in IoT Prototyping: Design Guidelines for Accessible Making Toolkits
Special Topics in Information Technology (2026)
- Full Paper Morra, D., Mora, S., Woo, M., Lee, S., Kumar, A., Duarte, F., & Ratti, C.
Exploring Citizens' Perceptions of Urban Well-Being Through a Card-Based Game
CHI26 – The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems
- Journal paper Morra, D., Caslini, G., Mores, M., Matera, M., Garzotto, F.
MakeNodes: Opening connected-IoT Making to People with Intellectual Disability
International Journal of Human-Computer Studies (2024)
- Journal paper Gennari, R., Matera, M., Melonio, A., Mores, M., Morra, D., & Rizvi, M.
A Toolkit for Engaging People with Intellectual Disabilities in Rapid Prototyping
International Journal of Human-Computer Studies (2024)
- Journal paper Morra, D., Zhu, X., Liu, C., Fu, K., Duarte, F., Mora, S., He, Z., & Ratti, C.
Mapping sidewalks accessibility with smartphone imagery and visual AI: A participatory approach
Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society A: Mathematical, Physical and Engineering (2024)
- Short paper Andrao, M., Morra, D., Paccosi, T., Matera, M., Treccani, B., Zancanaro, M.
“This Sounds Unclear”: Evaluating ChatGPT capability in translating end-user prompts into ready-to-deploy Python Code.
Proceedings of the 2024 International Conference on Advanced Visual Interfaces (AVI 24)
- Short paper Gibelli, E., M., Morra, D., Gelsomini, M., Matera, M.
Improving Swim Accessibility through VibroTactile Sensory Substitution: A Preliminary Study
Biannual Conference of the Italian SIGCHI Chapter
- Journal paper Gennari, R., Matera, M., Morra, D., Melonio, A., & Rizvi, M.
Design for social digital well-being with young generations: Engage them and make them reflect
International Journal of Human-Computer Studies
- Journal paper Caiola, V., Cusumano, E., Motta, M., Piro, L., Gelsomini, M., Morra, D., Rizvi, M., & Matera, M.
Designing integrated physical-digital systems for children-nature interaction
International Journal of Child-Computer Interaction
- Workshop paper Morra, D., & Rizvi, M.
Enhancing Students' Critical Reflection on Smart Things Design Through an End-User Development Toolkit
International EMPATHY Workshop: Empowering People in Dealing with Internet of Things Ecosystems
- Demo paper Gennari, R., Matera, M., Melonio, A., Morra, D., & Rizvi, M.
Ready, Steady, Go: Playing and Rapidly Designing with IoTgo
Proceedings of the 2022 International Conference on Advanced Visual Interfaces

<u>Full Paper</u>	Gennari, R., Matera, M., Morra, D., & Rizvi, M. Phygita Toolkit for Rapidly Designing Smart Things at School <i>International Conference on Advanced Visual Interfaces</i>
<u>Workshop Paper</u>	Gennari, R., Matera, M., Morra, D., Puglisi, F., & Rizvi, M. Designing for Digital Social Well-being: a Different and Inclusive Perspective <i>Designing for Meaningful Interactions and Digital Wellbeing</i>
<u>Workshop Paper</u>	Morra, D., Cosentino, G., Gelsomini, M., Matera, M., & Mores, M. Empowering Young Adults with Intellectual Disability to Design Smart Interactive Experiences <i>International EMPATHY Workshop: Empowering People in Dealing with Internet of Things Ecosystems</i>
<u>Full Paper</u>	Cosentino, G., Morra, D., Matera, M., Gelsomini, M., Mores, M. COBO: A Card-based Toolkit for Co-designing Smart Outdoor Experiences with People with Intellectual Disability <i>18th IFIP TC13 International Conference On Human-Computer Interaction</i>
<u>Workshop Paper</u>	Matera, M., Cosentino, G., Mores, M., Morra, D. A Card-based Toolkit for Co-Designing Smart Interactive Experiences with Subjects with Neurodevelopmental Disorders <i>International EMPATHY Workshop: Empowering People in Dealing with Internet of Things Ecosystems</i>

Conference activities

Programm Committee (PC)	AVI 2026 <i>International Conference on Advanced Visual Interfaces</i> ASSETS 2026 <i>International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility</i> ECSCW 2026 <i>EUSSET Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work</i>
Paper review	CHI (2026, 2023) <i>The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems</i> DIS 2026 <i>ACM Designing Interactive Systems</i> INTERACT (2025, 2023, 2021) <i>IFIP TC13 International Conference On Human-Computer Interaction</i> CSCW (2025, 2024) <i>The ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social</i> IJGI 2024 <i>ISPRS International Journal of Geo-Information</i> IJCCI 2024 <i>International Journal of Child-Computer Interaction</i> MobileHCI (2024, 2023) <i>The ACM International Conference on Mobile Human-Computer Interaction</i> IDC 2022 <i>ACM Interaction Design and Children (IDC) Conference</i>

International research projects

2022 – 2023 **EIT digital 2022 Innovation Activity**

Develop of the next generation of a senior monitoring solution. This improved solution will be tested and evaluated in two pilot projects – one in Finland and one in Italy. The main objectives are to evaluate usability and functionality and to obtain valuable input for further improvements.

Project partners:

- Forum Virium Helsinki
- Politecnico di Milano
- T.net S.p.A.

Teaching and Seminar activity

2025 **Invited Talk – "Make Cities Talk Back"**
Data Science for Common Good international webinar

2025 **Guest Lecturer – "Giving Sense to Sensing"**
Human–Computer Interaction for Business
Informatics and Management of Digital Business programme, Libera Università di Bolzano.

2024 **Invited Talk**
Social Entrepreneurship
Master degree in Management Engineering, Politecnico di Milano.

2 years **Teaching Assistant**
Inclusive Digital Technologies
Master degree in Industrial and Information Engineering, Politecnico di Milano.

2 years **Teaching Assistant**
Design for complexity (Workshop)
Master degree in Product-Service System Design, Politecnico di Milano.

2 years **Tutoring**
MSc Students
Master degree in Communication Design, School of Design, Politecnico di Milano.

4 years **Teaching Assistant**
Interaction Design Lab
Master degree in Communication Design, School of Design, Politecnico di Milano.

5 years **Teaching Assistant**
Il Fotografo e il progetto
Bachelor degree in Communication Design, School of Design, Politecnico di Milano.

Certifications

Native language Italian
Foreign language English
TOEFL IBT: 89/120 – July 2021
TOEIC: C2 (940/990) – June 2018
TONG: 27/30 – 7 August 2015

Use of personal data

“In compliance with the Italian Legislative Decree no. 196 dated 30/06/2003, I hereby authorize the recipient of this document to use and process my personal details for the purpose of recruiting and selecting staff and I confirm to be informed of my rights in accordance to art. 7 of the above mentioned decree.”